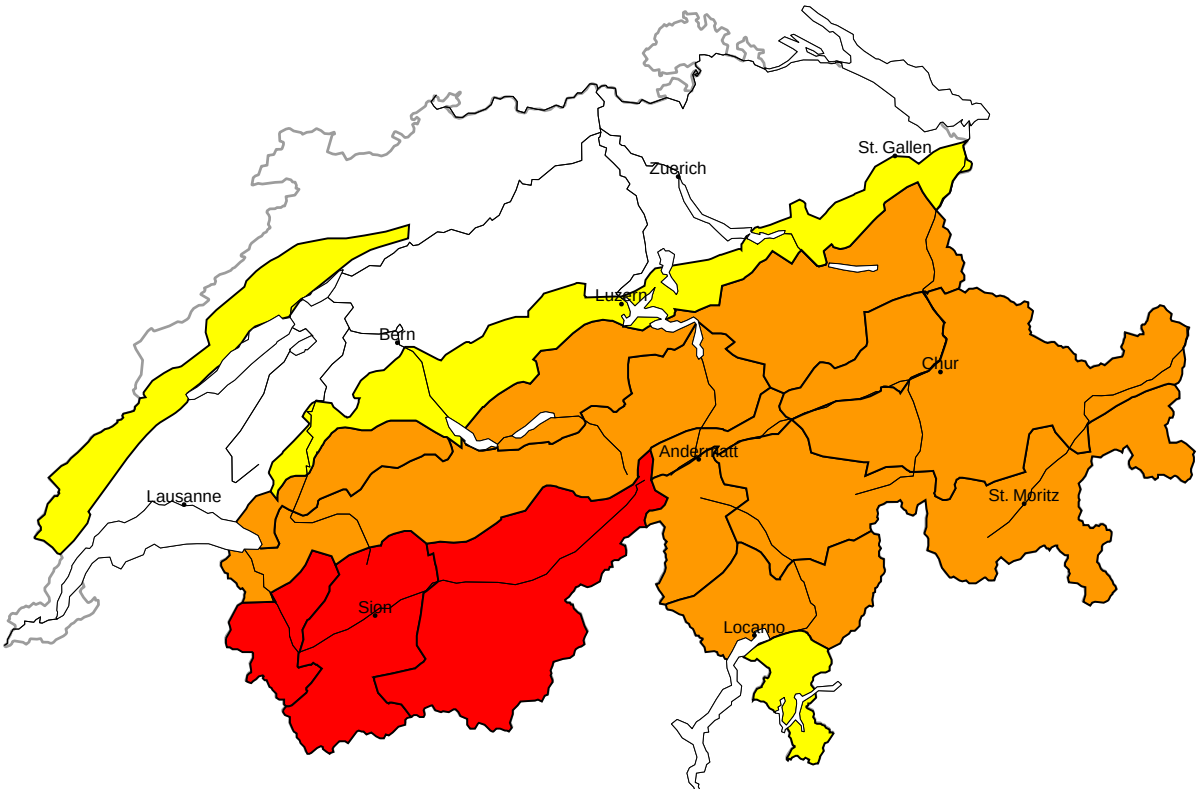
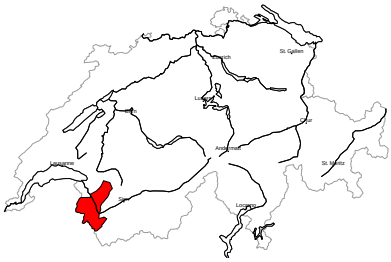
Avalanche danger

updated on 11.2.2026, 08:00



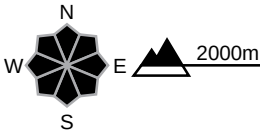
region A

High (4=)



New snow, Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations



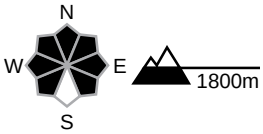
Danger description

Large quantities of fresh snow and the wind-drifted snow are lying on top of a weakly bonded old snowpack. Avalanches can in many places be released easily or triggered naturally. As the day progresses as a consequence of new snow and strong wind there will be an increase in the avalanche danger within the current danger level. Very large avalanches are to be expected. Exposed parts of transportation routes are endangered. The conditions are unfavourable for backcountry touring and other off-piste activities outside marked and open pistes.

Moderate (2)

Wet snow

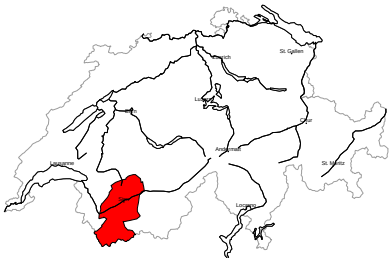
Avalanche prone locations



Danger description

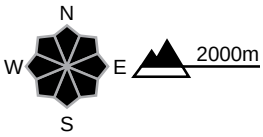
Wet snow slides and avalanches are to be expected as a consequence of the rain. These can reach medium size. The avalanche prone locations are to be found in gullies and bowls. Apart from the danger of being buried, restraint should be exercised in particular in view of the danger of avalanches sweeping people along and giving rise to falls.

region B — High (4=)



New snow, Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations

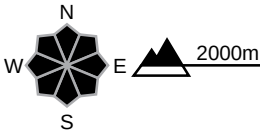


Danger description
Large quantities of fresh snow and the wind-drifted snow are lying on top of a weakly bonded old snowpack. Avalanches can in many places be released easily or triggered naturally. As the day progresses as a consequence of new snow and strong wind there will be an increase in the avalanche danger within the current danger level. Very large avalanches are to be expected. Exposed parts of transportation routes are endangered. The conditions are unfavourable for backcountry touring and other off-piste activities outside marked and open pistes.

region C — High (4-)

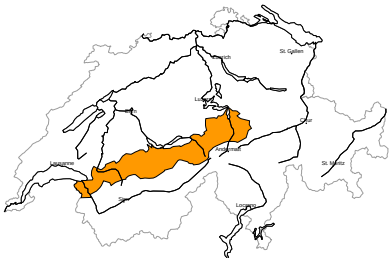
New snow, Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations



Danger description
Large quantities of fresh snow and the wind-drifted snow are lying on top of a weakly bonded old snowpack. Avalanches can in many places be released easily or triggered naturally. As the day progresses as a consequence of new snow and strong wind there will be an increase in the avalanche danger within the current danger level. More frequent very large avalanches are to be expected. Exposed parts of transportation routes are endangered to an increasing extent. The conditions are unfavourable for backcountry touring and other off-piste activities outside marked and open pistes.

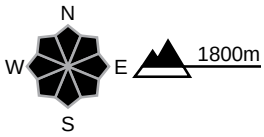
region D



Considerable (3+)

New snow, Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations

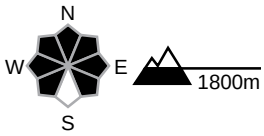


Danger description
Large quantities of fresh snow and the wind-drifted snow are lying on top of a weakly bonded old snowpack. Avalanches can be released by a single winter sport participant. They can in some cases penetrate deep layers. More frequent natural avalanches are possible. Avalanches can reach large size.
Backcountry touring and other off-piste activities call for caution and restraint.

Moderate (2)

Wet snow

Avalanche prone locations



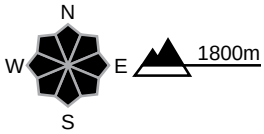
Danger description
Wet snow slides and avalanches are to be expected as a consequence of the rain. These can reach medium size. The avalanche prone locations are to be found in gullies and bowls. Apart from the danger of being buried, restraint should be exercised in particular in view of the danger of avalanches sweeping people along and giving rise to falls.

region E

Considerable (3+)

New snow, Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations

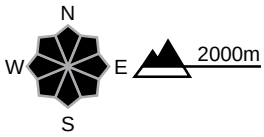


Danger description
Large quantities of fresh snow and the wind-drifted snow are lying on top of a weakly bonded old snowpack. Avalanches can be released by a single winter sport participant. They can in some cases penetrate deep layers. More frequent natural avalanches are possible. Avalanches can reach large size.
Backcountry touring and other off-piste activities call for caution and restraint.

region F — Considerable (3+)

New snow, Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations

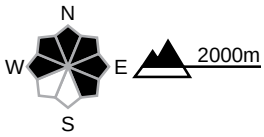


Danger description
The new snow and wind slabs are lying on top of a weakly bonded old snowpack. Avalanches can be triggered in deep layers and reach large size. Remotely triggered avalanches are possible. Whumpfing sounds and the formation of shooting cracks when stepping on the snowpack and fresh avalanches indicate the danger. Backcountry touring and other off-piste activities call for extensive experience in the assessment of avalanche danger and restraint.

region G — Considerable (3+)

Persistent weak layers

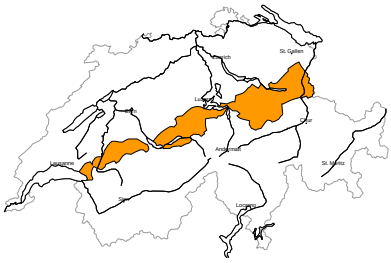
Avalanche prone locations



Danger description
Distinct weak layers in the old snowpack necessitate caution. Avalanches can be triggered in deep layers and reach large size in isolated cases. The avalanche prone locations are prevalent. Remotely triggered avalanches are to be expected. Whumpfing sounds and the formation of shooting cracks when stepping on the snowpack and fresh avalanches indicate the danger. Backcountry touring and other off-piste activities call for extensive experience in the assessment of avalanche danger and restraint.

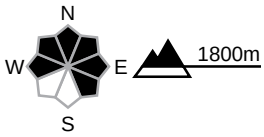
region H

Considerable (3=)



New snow, Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations

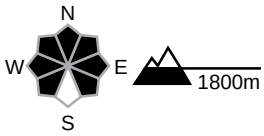


Danger description
The new snow and wind slabs are prone to triggering. Avalanches can be released by a single winter sport participant. They can in some cases penetrate deep layers and reach large size.
As the day progresses as a consequence of the snowfall there will be an additional increase in the danger. Individual natural avalanches are possible. Backcountry touring calls for experience in the assessment of avalanche danger.

Moderate (2)

Wet snow

Avalanche prone locations



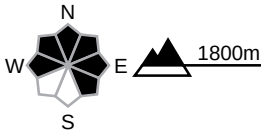
Danger description
Wet snow slides and avalanches are to be expected as a consequence of the rain. These can reach medium size. The avalanche prone locations are to be found in gullies and bowls. Apart from the danger of being buried, restraint should be exercised in particular in view of the danger of avalanches sweeping people along and giving rise to falls.

region I

Considerable (3=)

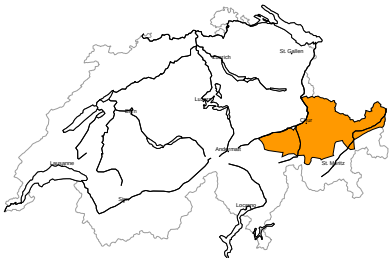
New snow, Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations



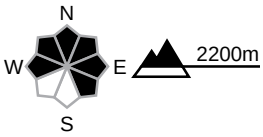
Danger description
The new snow and wind slabs are prone to triggering. Avalanches can be released by a single winter sport participant. They can in some cases penetrate deep layers and reach large size.
As the day progresses as a consequence of the snowfall there will be an additional increase in the danger. Individual natural avalanches are possible. Backcountry touring calls for experience in the assessment of avalanche danger.

region J — Considerable (3=)



Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations

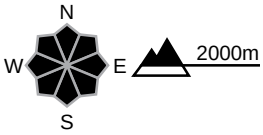


Danger description
Weak layers in the old snowpack necessitate caution. Even single snow sport participants can release avalanches. These can be triggered in deep layers and reach large size in isolated cases. Remotely triggered avalanches are to be expected. Whumpfing sounds and the formation of shooting cracks when stepping on the snowpack and fresh avalanches can indicate the danger.
Backcountry touring and other off-piste activities call for extensive experience in the assessment of avalanche danger.

region K — Considerable (3=)

Persistent weak layers

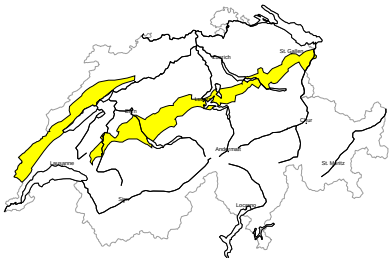
Avalanche prone locations



Danger description
Weak layers in the old snowpack necessitate caution. Even single snow sport participants can release avalanches. These can be triggered in deep layers and reach large size in isolated cases. Remotely triggered avalanches are possible. Whumpfing sounds and the formation of shooting cracks when stepping on the snowpack and fresh avalanches can indicate the danger.
Backcountry touring and other off-piste activities call for extensive experience in the assessment of avalanche danger.

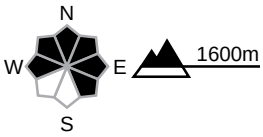
region L

Moderate (2+)



Wind slab

Avalanche prone locations

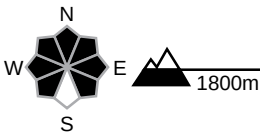


Danger description
As a consequence of new snow and a strong westerly wind, sometimes avalanche prone wind slabs will form. Avalanches can reach medium size. The fresh wind slabs are to be evaluated with care and prudence in particular in very steep terrain.

Moderate (2)

Wet snow

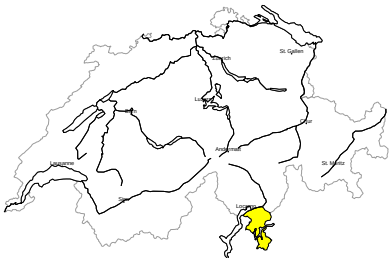
Avalanche prone locations



Danger description
Wet snow slides and avalanches are to be expected as a consequence of the rain. These can reach medium size. The avalanche prone locations are to be found in gullies and bowls. Apart from the danger of being buried, restraint should be exercised in particular in view of the danger of avalanches sweeping people along and giving rise to falls.

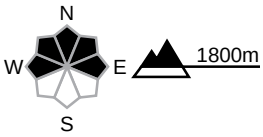
region M

Moderate (2+)



Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations



Danger description
Distinct weak layers exist in the old snowpack. Avalanches can in some places be released by a single winter sport participant. Avalanches can be triggered in deep layers and reach medium size.
Backcountry touring and other off-piste activities call for defensive route selection.

Snowpack and weather

updated on 10.2.2026, 17:00

Snowpack

There is appreciably less snow in all regions than is usual for the time of year, especially at low and intermediate altitudes. The large amounts of fresh snow expected in the west and north over the next few days will fall on a snowpack that is unfavourable in many areas, the surface of the snowpack being faceted and loose in many places. In addition, there are distinct weak layers that are prone to triggering in the middle and lower parts of the snowpack, especially on western, northern and eastern slopes, particularly south of a line from the Rhone to the Rhine. North of this, the snowpack structure is somewhat more favourable, but even in these regions there are weak layers deeper in the old snowpack. Against this background, a rapid and significant increase in avalanche danger is in prospect, especially in the west and north.

Weather review for Tuesday

Conditions were overcast on Tuesday, with light precipitation in almost all regions and with snowfall levels of between 1000 and 1500 m.

Fresh snow
The following amounts fell up to Tuesday afternoon:
- Jura, extreme west of Lower Valais, northern Lower Valais, Ticino: 5 to 15 cm
- elsewhere less or dry

Temperature
At midday at 2000 m, between -2°C in the north and -4°C in the south

Wind
Rising west to southwesterly, which, in the afternoon, was:
- moderate to strong in the Jura and on the northern flank of the Alps
- elsewhere light to moderate

Weather forecast to Wednesday

In the north, conditions will be very cloudy with precipitation. This will be heaviest in northern and the extreme west of Lower Valais and in the Vaud Alps. The snowfall level will rise in the west overnight to Wednesday to 2000 m and then drop to 1300 m. In Valais, it will be lower at times. In the south, conditions will be very cloudy overnight to Wednesday with some precipitation, while daytime conditions will be quite sunny.

Fresh snow
Above 2200 m:
- northern and extreme west of Lower Valais, Vaud Alps: 50 to 80 cm
- remaining western and central parts of the northern flank of the Alps, rest of Valais: 30 to 50 cm
- eastern part of the northern flank of the Alps, southern Simplon region, northern Ticino, Surselva and Prättigau: 15 to 30 cm
- rest of Ticino and rest of Grisons: 5 to 15 cm

Temperature
At midday at 2000 m, between -2 °C in the north and 0 °C in the south

Wind
- Along the Prealps, strong to storm-force westerly to southwesterly in the west and north at high altitudes
- In Ticino and Grisons mostly moderate, initially from the southwest, then from the northwest

Outlook for Thursday and Friday

Thursday
In the north, conditions will continue to be very cloudy with persistent, heavy precipitation at times. The westerly wind will remain strong to storm-force, especially on the northern flank of the Alps and in the west. The amount of fresh snow is expected to be similar to that of the day before. The snowfall level will be between 1100 and 1300 m.
Avalanche danger will increase further generally, within level 4 in regions exposed to the most precipitation. An increased number of very large avalanches is expected in these regions, these being capable of descending right down into the valleys in the regular avalanche tracks and of endangering exposed transportation routes.

Friday
During the night to Friday, another 20 to 40 cm of snow will fall on the northern flank of the Alps, in Lower Valais and Prättigau, but less in the rest of Valais and Grisons. The snowfall level will be between 1000 and 1200 m. Conditions will be dry on the southern flank of the Alps. During the day, conditions will be cloudy with brighter intervals on the northern flank of the Alps and mostly sunny in Valais and the south. The westerly wind will subside significantly.
Avalanche danger will increase again somewhat overnight to Friday and may reach dangerlevel 4 even on the eastern part of the northern flank of the Alps and in northern Grisons. Very large avalanches are possible on the northern flank of the Alps, these being capable of descending right down into the valleys and endangering exposed transportation routes. In Grisons, on the other hand, the risk relates primarily to alpine snow sports terrain.